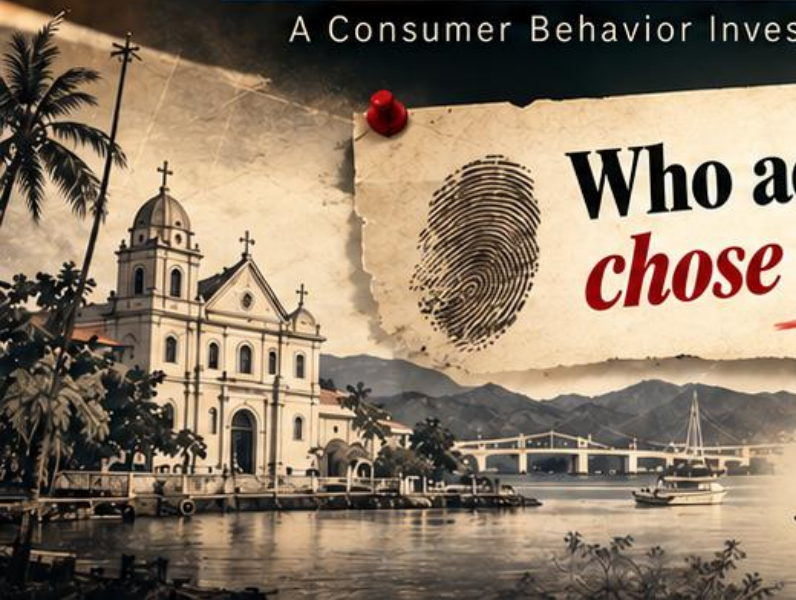
CASE 001

THE MISSING BOTTLE

Why They Don't Buy Amlan

A Consumer Behavior Investigation

Who actually *chose* the brand?









Using the customer buying journey lens of Martyn R. Lewis.

CASE 002

MEET THE BOOK

Martyn R. Lewis

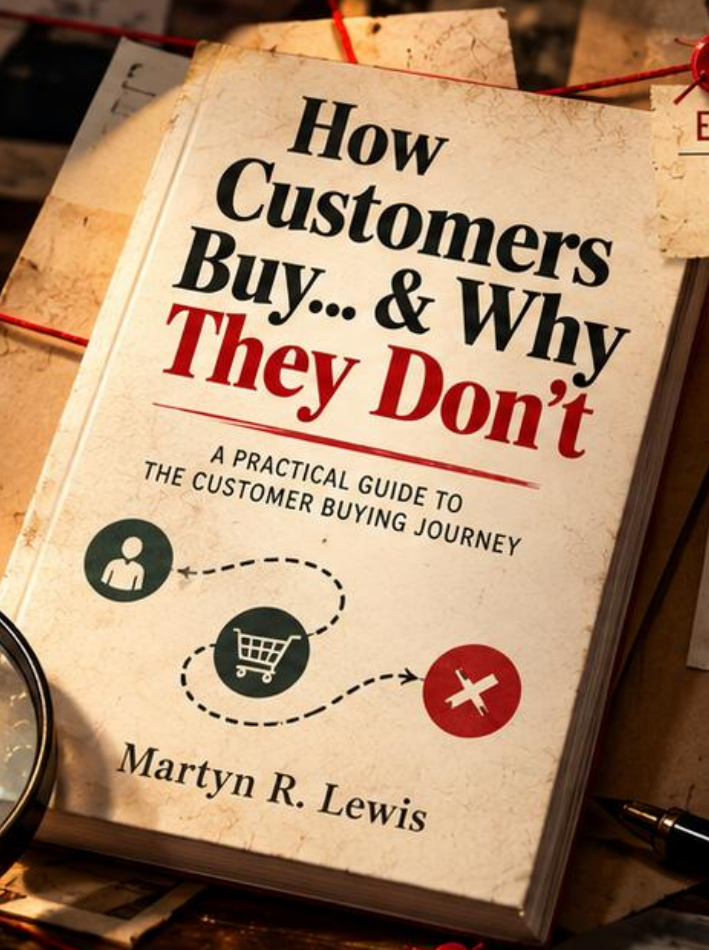


EXHIBIT A

The Book (Evidence)



- ☑ OBSERVE
- ☑ UNDERSTAND
- ☑ ANALYZE
- ☑ EXPLAIN

BIG IDEA

Start with how customers buy, not how companies sell.

WHY IT MATTERS

Good products still lose when the **buying journey is broken.**

MBA TAKE

Marketing works better when it fits the **customer journey.**

CASE 003

LEWIS FLIPS THE QUESTION

Seller-First

How do we sell more?



Outside-In Thinking

Customer-First

How do customers actually buy?



DISCOVER
Recognize a need and explore options.

EVALUATE
Compare brands, read reviews, ask others.

CHOOSE
Make a purchase based on what fits their needs.

LOYALTY
Keep buying when it delivers value.

CUSTOMER MOVES AT THEIR OWN PACE



Lewis says the customer journey should *shape sales and marketing*, not the other way around.



CASE 004

THE CUSTOMER BUYING JOURNEY DNA





1 TRIGGERS



What starts the journey.

2 STEPS



What the customer does.

3 KEY PLAYERS



Who influences the purchase.

4 BUYING STYLE



How the customer chooses.

5 VALUE DRIVERS



What matters most.

6 BUYING CONCERNS



What blocks or slows the purchase.



Lewis Lens: *A complete view of the customer's buying journey.*

CASE 005

LEWIS'S 4Q BUYING STYLE

CHOICE

VALUE

CHOICE / PRODUCT



Sort and Select

CHOICE / SOLUTION



VALUE / PRODUCT



VALUE / SOLUTION



But *not every buyer* fits the same box.

Lewis Lens:

Many bottled water purchases are **quick**, **low-involvement** choices among acceptable brands.





OBSERVE
UNDERSTAND
ANALYZE
EXPLAIN

CASE 006

WHY CUSTOMERS DON'T BUY



NOT AWARE

Customers don't know the brand or product exists.



NOT VISIBLE

Hard to find at the right place or in the right channels.



NOT AVAILABLE

Out of stock or not available in the right size, variant, or location.



NOT TRUSTED

Concerns about quality, safety, or credibility hold them back.



TOO EXPENSIVE

Price is higher than expected or higher than perceived value.

TAKEAWAY:

Good products still lose when the buying journey is broken.

Buying concerns are the friction points that block, slow, or stop purchase.

CASE 007

THE FOUR SALES & MARKETING IMPERATIVES

UNDERSTAND THE JOURNEY
DRIVE BEHAVIOR
CREATE VALUE
THAT LASTS



1 INITIATE



Start the journey.

2 COMPLETE



Help the buyer finish.

3 EXPEDITE



Make it easier and faster.

4 AUGMENT



Grow the value of the purchase.



Marketing should move the journey,
not just shout about the product.

CASE 008

BEFORE WE STUDY AMLAN

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥

1 Follow the buyer, not the seller.



Understand real customer behavior.

2 Availability is part of value.



☑ IN STOCK TODAY

If it's not there, it can't be chosen.

3 Friction kills sales.



So why doesn't Amlan *enter the buying journey?*

NEXT STEP:

Now we follow how people actually buy water. →



CASE 009

CASE FILE: AMLAN PURIFIED WATER

WHO:

Purified water brand



COMPANY SAYS CUSTOMERS CHOOSE IT FOR:

- Price
- Taste

WHERE:

General trade + institutional / event channels





MAIN CHALLENGE:

Stock / Production Capacity



WHY THIS CASE?

Everyday product. Many substitutes. Real local buying friction.

CASE 010

WHAT AMLAN MANAGEMENT BELIEVES

MANAGEMENT VIEW

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥



1 WHY CUSTOMERS CHOOSE AMLAN

Price + Taste



3 RETAILERS

Very Important



MANAGEMENT

2 WHY THEY CHOOSE OTHERS

Price + Availability



4 BIGGEST CHALLENGE

Stock / Production Capacity



⚠ This is the company hypothesis — not yet our conclusion.

CASE 011

HOW WE INVESTIGATED THE JOURNEY

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥

1

87

ELIGIBLE SURVEY RESPONDENTS



81 Philippines-based for Amlan analysis

2

6

CONSUMER INTERVIEWS



3

6

RETAILER INTERVIEWS





4

13

STORE OBSERVATIONS



5

1

AMLAN COMPANY INTERVIEW



TRIANGULATION:

We looked for patterns that appeared across different sources.

! Exploratory convenience sample — not representative of all Filipino consumers.

CASE 012

A REAL BUYING JOURNEY IS SURPRISINGLY SHORT

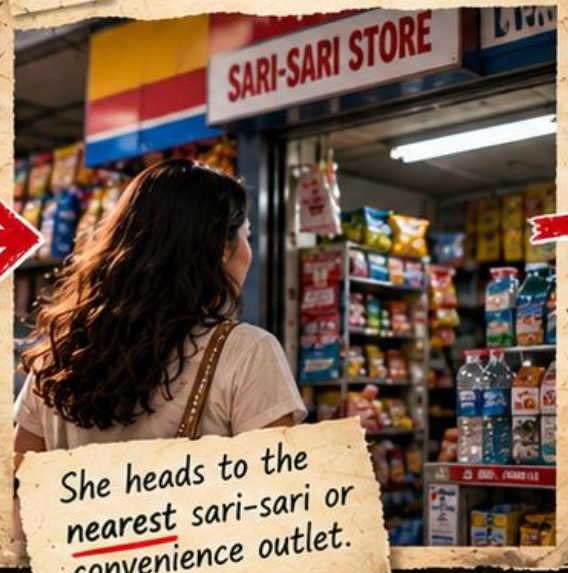
REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥

1 TRIGGER



Mara is out and it's hot. She's thirsty.

2 NEAREST OUTLET



She heads to the nearest sari-sari or convenience outlet.

3 WHAT'S AVAILABLE & COLD



She sees cold bottled water in the refrigerator.

4 BUY



A quick and easy purchase.

JUST A FEW SECONDS

For many single-bottle purchases, *the journey can happen in seconds.*





CASE 013

THE TRIGGER COMES BEFORE THE BRAND

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥













?

5 of 6 consumer interviews described immediate or situational purchases.

The journey often starts with the situation — *not with a brand name.*

CASE 014

THE RETAILER QUIETLY BECOMES A KEY PLAYER

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥



- What is stocked.
- What is cold.
- What is easy to reach.
- What gets handed over.







In low-involvement moments, the retailer and assortment can shape the final choice.

CASE 015

SORT & SELECT... BUT NOT EVERYONE

REAL PEOPLE REAL CHOICES ♥

SOURCE
TASTE-ORIENTED BUYER



- Prioritizes taste and water quality.
- Willing to try different brands.

THE LEWIS 4Q

1 SOURCE
Why do they buy?

2 CHOICE / PRODUCT
What do they buy?
SORT & SELECT



4 of 6 interviews

3 CONTEXT
Where & when do they buy?

4 QUANTITY
How much do they buy?

PLANNED BULK
HOUSEHOLD BUYER



- Buys in larger quantities for the household.
- Focuses on value, convenience and availability.

LEWIS LENS

Different buying patterns may point to different markets or submarkets.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Bottled water is often low-involvement, but not every buyer follows the same journey.

CASE 016 —

WHAT MATTERS MOST?

Survey evidence shows practical value drivers dominate bottled-water choice.

EVIDENCE 1:

AVERAGE IMPORTANCE SCORES
(1 = Not important, 5 = Very important)



Among eligible survey respondents.

EVIDENCE 2:

56% reject a brand if it feels too expensive.

52% reject if the seal or bottle looks unsafe.

Among eligible survey respondents.

KEY FINDING:

Practical value beats fancy features.

CASE 017

THE FUNNEL LEAKS BEFORE TRIAL

PHILIPPINES

ELIGIBLE RESPONDENTS (n = 81)









63% — **Unfamiliar**
Have not heard of Amlan

37% — **Aware of Amlan**
Have heard of Amlan

22% — **Tried / Consumed Amlan**
Have tried or consumed Amlan

11% — **Purchased Amlan themselves**
Have personally purchased Amlan

EVIDENCE NOTE:

The product cannot win on taste if the customer never reaches trial.

CASE 018

WHEN THE STORY GETS REAL, COLDNESS APPEARS.



REAL PEOPLE
REAL PLACES
REAL PURCHASE STORIES



INT. 1
Convenience Store
Cebu City



INT. 2
Grocery Store
Mandaue



INT. 3
Sari-sari Store
Lapu-Lapu



INT. 4
Supermarket
Cebu City



INT. 5
Wet Market
Talisay



INT. 6
Carinderia
Consolacion

KEY FINDINGS FROM 6 CONSUMER INTERVIEWS

PRICE / AVAILABILITY

6 of 6

"Easy to find." "Affordable."
"Always available."

COLDNESS

5 of 6

"Tastes better when cold."
"I always look for a cold one."
"Not the same if it's not cold."

SAFETY / TRUST

5 of 6

"Trusted brand."
"Feels safe."
"Sure quality."

TASTE

2 of 6

"Okay lang ang taste."
"It's just normal."
"Not my main reason."

TAKEAWAY:

In real purchase stories, coldness becomes highly visible.

Qualitative interview themes, not population percentages.

MAS MASARAP PAG COLD.

EVIDENCE

CEBU
MARKET INVESTIGATION

CASE 019 — CUSTOMERS OFTEN ASK FOR WATER, NOT A BRAND

Qualitative evidence from six retailer interviews in Cebu

Findings are based on in-depth conversations with 6 retailers (not population percentages).

SIX RETAILER INTERVIEWS

Different retail settings across Cebu



1. SARI-SARI STORE
Residential neighborhood



2. PHARMACY
Community pharmacy



3. TERMINAL STORE
Passenger terminal



4. SCHOOL-AREA STORE
Near schools / campuses



5. CARINDERIA / GOVERNMENT-OFFICE STORE
Near offices / work arees



6. NEIGHBORHOOD STORE
Mixed residential area

5 of 6

most customers simply ask for bottled water.

"Usually, tubig lang gyud ang ilang pangutana."

6 of 6

say coldness matters.

"Mas daghan gyud mupalit kung bugnaw."

0 of 6

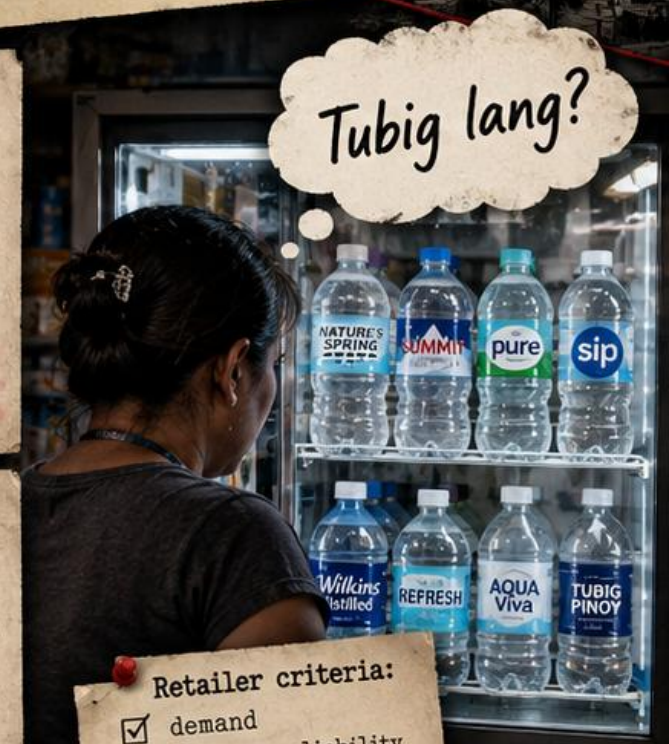
currently stock Amlan.

"Wala pa jud mi kabaligya og Amlan."

5 of 6

do not have a clear Amlan sales / distributor contact.

"Wala mi klarong kinsa ang ma-contact."



Retailer criteria:

- ☑ demand
- ☑ delivery reliability
- ☑ price / margin
- ☑ low stocking risk.

KEY FINDING

The retailer is not just a shelf. The retailer helps shape the choice set.

IT STARTS ON EVERYDAY SHELVES.

CEBU

CASE 020

WHERE IS AMLAN?

Store observation evidence.

Cebu

Field Investigation
Retail Outlets
Store Displays

13 RETAIL OUTLETS OBSERVED


#1 Convenience Store


#2 Supermarket


#3 Grocery


#4 Convenience Store


#5 Supermarket


#6 Grocery


#7 Convenience Store



#8 Supermarket



#9 Grocery


#10 Convenience Store



#11 Supermarket



#12 Grocery


#13 Convenience Store



COMPETITOR VISIBILITY IN PHOTOGRAPHED DISPLAYS

		OUT OF 13 OUTLETS
Amlan	?	**0 / 13**
Nature's Spring		11 / 13
Absolute		8 / 13
Wilkins		8 / 13
Refresh		6 / 13
Evian		5 / 13
Refrigerated bottled water visible (any brand)		11 / 13

EVIDENCE NOTE: Amlan was not visible in the photographed displays.

CAUTION: This does not prove the outlets did not carry Amlan elsewhere in the store.

If the brand is not visible at the moment of choice, it may never enter consideration.

CASE 021

PLOT TWIST:
THE EVIDENCE DOESN'T ALWAYS AGREE

CEBU
Different perspectives. A fuller truth.



COLDNESS

SURVEY
3.43 / 5
importance



CONSUMER INTERVIEWS
5 of 6
mentioned coldness.

RETAILER INTERVIEWS
6 of 6
said coldness matters.



STORE OBSERVATIONS
refrigerated bottled water visible in
11 of 13
outlets.

General attitude ≠ purchase-moment importance.

This is not bad data.

Different methods reveal different parts of behavior.

SUSTAINABILITY

SURVEY
4.12 / 5
agree it is important to choose eco-friendly packaging.



"I want to be more sustainable but..."

IN REAL PURCHASE STORIES,
other factors dominate:

PRICE	AVAILABILITY	COLDNESS	SAFETY	CONVENIENCE
"It fits my budget."	*"It's conveniently there."*	*"I want it cold."*	*"I know it's safe."*	*"Easy to bring."*

Positive attitude, weaker purchase influence.

Cebu
Hot days. Colder choices.

CLEANER CEBU BRIGHTER TOMORROW

CONTEXT CHANGES WHAT MATTERS.

Survey = stated importance.
Interviews/retailers/store audit = situational evidence.

CASE 022

WHERE THE JOURNEY ACTUALLY BREAKS.

Amian
FIELD RESEARCH
CEBU
2024

SURVEY

63% unfamiliar.

CONSUMER INTERVIEWS

coldness repeatedly matters.

RETAILER INTERVIEWS

5 of 6 retailers lack clear Amlan contact.

STORE OBSERVATIONS

0 of 13 photographed displays showed Amlan.

COMPANY INTERVIEW

company cites stock / production capacity.

1 AWARENESS !

2 RETAILER ACCESS !

3 VISIBLE / COLD STOCK !

4 TRIAL !

5 PRODUCT VALUE

6 REPEAT

MAIN FRICTION ZONE

CONCLUSION

THE BIGGER PROBLEM APPEARS TO HAPPEN BEFORE PRODUCT EVALUATION.

LEWIS LENS

Friction can block completion before value has a chance to work.

Cebu People Stores Product Journey

CASE 023

VERDICT: LEWIS STILL WORKS — BUT THE JOURNEY IS COMPRESSED.

Cebu

Field. Investigation
Retail Outlets
Store Displays

WHAT FITS

- Trigger
- Steps
- Key Players
- Buying Style
- Value Drivers
- Buying Concerns

All six still appear in bottled-water purchases.

WHAT CHANGES





The journey may happen **in seconds.**

Situation and availability become more powerful.

WHAT LEWIS HELPS US SEE

Learn	Feel
Choice Product Sort & Select	Habit



Commodity-like purchases often fit **Choice/Product: Sort & Select.**

CAUTION: Not every buyer follows the same journey: single-bottle, bulk household, and institutional buying behave differently.

OUR VERDICT: USE THE FRAMEWORK — BUT ADAPT IT TO LOW-INVOLVEMENT, SITUATIONAL BUYING.

CASE 024

THE REAL PROBLEM IS UPSTREAM.

Amlan may be losing before product evaluation begins.

Cebu

Field Investigation
Retail Outlets
Store Displays

63% unfamiliar with Amlan.

5 of 6 retailers lack a clear Amlan sales/distributor contact.

0 of 13 photographed displays showed visible Amlan.

Company cites stock / production capacity.

⚠ AWARENESS



Consumers are unfamiliar with Amlan.

⚠ RETAILER ACCESS



Retailers lack a clear Amlan sales/distributor contact.

⚠ AVAILABILITY



Amlan is not available on shelf.

⚠ VISIBILITY / COLD STOCK



No visible displays and likely cold/hidden stock.

⚠ TRIAL



Consumers cannot try Amlan.

PRODUCT VALUE



When tried, consumers see product value (e.g. quality, taste).

REPEAT



Satisfied consumers are likely to repeat purchase.

DIAGNOSIS:

This is not only a persuasion problem.
It is also an access and execution problem.

LEWIS LENS:

Friction can stop a journey before value has a chance to work.

CASE 025

MISSION 1:

FIX ACCESS BEFORE BUYING MORE ADVERTISING.

CURRENT ROUTE (BROKEN)



AMLAN


SALES / DISTRIBUTOR CONTACT


RETAILER


COLD STOCK


CUSTOMER

RECOMMENDED ROUTE (FIXED)



AMLAN


SALES / DISTRIBUTOR CONTACT


RETAILER


COLD STOCK


CUSTOMER

THREE KEY ACTIONS

1. Create one clear retailer ordering/ contact channel.
2. Prioritize reliable replenishment and delivery routes.
3. Track stockouts and retailer service levels.

KEY EVIDENCE

5/6 retailers lacked clear Amlan contact.

Company identified stock availability / production capacity as a challenge.

MANAGER MOVE: **Complete + Expedite:** remove friction so the product can actually enter the choice set.

CASE 026

MISSION 2:
WIN THE MOMENT OF CHOICE.

Cebu

Field Investigation
Retail Outlets
Store Displays



VISIBLE

secure front-facing placement.



EASY

make the bottle easy for retailers to hand over.





COLD

prioritize chilled availability where immediate purchases happen.



TRIAL

use sampling or event exposure to move awareness into first use.



Retailers can become **Key Players** in low-involvement purchases.

For quick purchases, execution at the cooler can matter as much as communication.

CASE 027

ONE BRAND. DIFFERENT BUYING JOURNEYS.

Cebu

Field Investigation
Retail Outlets
Households
Institutions / Events

1. SINGLE-BOTTLE / ON-THE-GO

Quick purchase for immediate consumption while out and about.





BUYING JOURNEY

Trigger
(thirst, on-the-go, convenience)

→

Nearest outlet
(convenience store, gas station, kiosk)

→

Cold / available option
(visible, accessible)

→

Buy
(single bottle)

KEY PRIORITIES

- Availability
- Coldness
- Safety
- Price

2. HOUSEHOLD / BULK

Regular replenishment for home consumption and the whole family.





BUYING JOURNEY

Replenishment need
(running low, household use)

→

Family acceptance
(preferred brand, taste, trust)

→

Delivery / price
(promo, pack size, store or online)

→

Repeat
(regular purchase)

KEY PRIORITIES

- Convenience
- Value
- Taste
- Availability

3. INSTITUTIONAL / EVENTS

Large-volume purchases for businesses, organizations, and events.





BUYING JOURNEY

Volume requirement
(event size, (consumption plan)

→

Supplier evaluation
(brand, capacity, track record)

→

SLA / delivery reliability
(on-time, complete, conditions)

→

Order
(PO, contract, (repeat business)

KEY PRIORITIES

- Capacity
- Reliability
- Terms
- Service

LEWIS LENS: Different buying DNA can indicate different markets.

Do not market to 'the bottled-water buyer' as if there is only one.

Cebu

CASE 028

CASE CLOSED? NOT QUITE.

A 90-day plan to put Amlan where it belongs – in consumers' everyday moments.



More Moments. More People. A Healthier Cebu.

DAYS 1 - 30
MAP & FIX ACCESS

- **Retailer contact channel**
  Build and activate a list of target outlets.
- **Priority outlets**
  Focus on 13 key outlet types (e.g., convenience stores, supermarkets, groceries).
- **Stock/service baseline**
  Ensure initial supply, cold chain readiness, and consistent service.



Right Outlets. Right Start.

DAYS 31 - 60
PUT AMLAN IN THE MOMENT

- **Trial placements**
  Place Amlan in high-traffic, high-impulse locations.
- **Chilled visibility**
  Maximize cold shelf presence with clear Amlan branding.
- **Retailer activation**
  Provide simple materials, merchandising support, and in-store engagement.



Visible. Chilled. Chosen.

DAYS 61 - 90
MEASURE & SCALE

- **Awareness**
  Track brand visibility and recognition.
- **Trial**
  Grow first-time purchase rates.
- **Availability**
  Maintain and expand outlet coverage.
- **Repeat**
  Drive repeat purchase.
- **Retailer reorder**
  Turn trial into consistent reorders and scale to more outlets across Cebu.





Real People. Real Moments. That's the Win.

A BRAND CANNOT WIN A DECISION IT NEVER GETS THE CHANCE TO JOIN.

For low-involvement products, availability is part of consumer behavior.



